

Cat Litter Box Rescue Guide — Action Checklist

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RULE OUT MEDICAL CAUSES

- ☐ **Schedule Vet Visit:** Call your veterinarian and schedule an appointment for your cat because litter box avoidance that started recently is often a medical problem hiding behind what looks like bad behavior.
- ☐ **Request Lab Tests:** Ask your vet specifically for a urinalysis and blood work to check for urinary tract infections, kidney disease, and diabetes because these conditions cause cats to urinate outside the box due to pain or increased urine volume.
- ☐ **Watch for Blockage Signs:** If you own a male cat, tell your vet immediately about any straining, crying, or producing only small amounts of urine because a urinary blockage can be life-threatening within hours.
- ☐ **Budget for Diagnostics:** Plan to spend \$100 to \$300 on veterinary testing because ruling out medical causes is less expensive than replacing carpet or flooring and it protects your cat from serious illness.

FIX LITTER BOX SETUP

- ☐ **Apply the N+1 Rule:** Place one litter box per cat plus one extra box in your home because cats are territorial and won't share elimination space, which forces weaker cats to find other places to pee.
- ☐ **Switch to Uncovered Boxes:** Replace any covered litter boxes with uncovered ones because covered boxes trap ammonia fumes that irritate your cat's sensitive nose and create blind spots where other cats can ambush them.
- ☐ **Choose the Right Box Size:** Use a box that is at least 1.5 times the length of your cat from nose to tail base because most store-bought boxes are too small and make cats feel cramped and vulnerable.
- ☐ **Place Boxes Strategically:** Set up litter boxes in quiet corners with two escape routes, away from food bowls, loud appliances, and high-traffic areas because cats need privacy and the ability to see threats coming from both directions.

REDUCE HOUSEHOLD STRESS

- ☐ **Install Feliway Diffusers:** Plug Feliway pheromone diffusers into rooms where your cat spends the most time and replace refills every 30 days because the calming pheromone signals help reduce stress-related elimination in multi-cat households.
 - ☐ **Create Vertical Territory:** Install cat trees, shelves, or window perches because cats feel safer up high and having elevated spaces reduces the anxiety that often triggers inappropriate urination.
 - ☐ **Add Hiding Spots:** Place cardboard boxes with blankets or covered pet carriers with beds in multiple rooms because having a fallback safe space in every area gives your cat somewhere to retreat when stress spikes.
 - ☐ **Schedule Daily Play Sessions:** Commit to 10 to 15 minutes of active play with wand toys or laser pointers each day because exercise burns off anxiety and a tired cat is a calmer, less stressed cat.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.